Company handbook

Born GmbH, knitwear for fashion & engineering
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Created: QMB
Release: GF
Creation date: 25.05.2021 / Release date: 26.05.2021
Version: 2 from 11.10.2021 / Release date: 11.10.2021
Version: 3 from 26.04.2022 / Release date: 27.04.2022
Version: 4 from 22/08/2022 / Release date: 22/08/2022
Version: 5 from 29.11.2022 / Release date: 29.11.2022
Version: 6 from 25.04.2023 / Release date: 25.04.2023

Change history

Creation date: 18.12.2023 / Release date: 18.12.2023
Amendment 1: dated 18/12/2023 - "Change history added."

Scope of application / context of the organisation

The requirements of ISO 9001 are implemented in the manual and in the applicable documents. The manual applies to all areas of Born GmbH, Poststraße 4, 37351 Dingelstädt.

Scope: the production and distribution of fashion, functional, technical, medical (non-sterile), knit-based textiles as well as the retail of these.

Target group / clientele: Medical technology manufacturers, manufacturers of sports goods, wholesalers, retailers, medical supply stores, clinics, end customers.

Non-applicable requirements: The requirements for sterile medical devices and research and development do not apply.

Outsourced processes: There are outsourced processes for the knitting, steaming and tailoring/finishing departments. The processes of financial accounting, personnel accounting, occupational safety, IT administration and support for legal matters by the law firm are also outsourced. The outsourced processes are subjected to a comprehensive and defined incoming goods inspection, compared with our quality guidelines and only passed on to the next production steps if they have been successfully inspected. Our internal processes have proven their worth.

Interested parties and their requirements:

a) Customers and end users: product quality and prices as well as adherence to delivery dates and transparency.
b) Employees: attractive working environment, job security, recognition and remuneration.
c) Suppliers, distributors/wholesalers, retailers and partners: mutual benefit and continuity.
d) Company / shareholders: Value enhancement as well as sustainable profitability, performance and sustainability.
e) Authority: Compliance with legal and regulatory requirements.
f) Environment / Neighbourhood: Respectful interaction with one another.
g) Associations: strengthening the network, compliance with association guidelines; support with legal issues.
h) Investors and shareholders: achieving return targets and liquidity targets
i) Insurer: Compliance with the insurance conditions, notification of changes

Their requirements are regularly determined and monitored via customer satisfaction, risk analysis, complaint recording and root cause analysis, employee feedback, internal audits, occupational safety, standards and laws.

1. About us

We produce and distribute textiles of all kinds, including technical, medical and lifestyle textiles, as well as orthoses.

Products from Born GmbH

Born GmbH, knitwear for fashion & engineering, based in Dingelstädt, is entered in the commercial register as a limited liability company. The company is registered at the local court 07745 Jena under the commercial register number HRB 401195. The company is economically active. The last change in the commercial register was made on 06.04.2022. The company is managed by a managing director. The proportion of women in management is approx. 65 per cent. The company is also active in foreign trade/export. The export share of turnover is included in our company data. The company operates from its location in Dingelstädt (DE). Processed items from the Polish partner company in Wielun (PL) are treated as items from an outsourced process and subjected to appropriate quality assurance measures.

2. Corporate policy & objectives

We have established a ***quality policy*** that fulfils the high expectations and wishes of our customers. The success of our customers and employees is at the centre of our actions. This policy forms the basis for our dealings with customers, employees, partners, resources and our environment. The quality management system is continuously improved.

The voluntary commitment to continuous improvement (CIP) applies to all processes. Appropriate documentation and review of the effectiveness of all resulting measures is carried out regularly.

Customers
Our aim is to provide products and services that fully satisfy our customers, both in terms of the products themselves and through short delivery times and high delivery reliability. Added to this is our high degree of flexibility in individual and series production, as well as the diversity of our fields of activity, which gives us stability even in difficult economic times. Comprehensive, customer-orientated advice is also a matter of course for us.

Employees
We are very proud of our high-performance team of highly motivated and well-trained specialists. They are highly committed to realising individual customer requirements and identify strongly with our company and our quality objectives.

Suppliers/ Partners

To ensure that the value chain always runs smoothly, we place the same high demands on our partners as we do on our own services. We achieve this through transparent, comprehensive communication and regular supplier evaluations.

Resources
It is very important to us to actively protect the environment and to use the required resources as sparingly and consciously as possible. All processes are continuously reviewed in this regard.

Environment
As we attach great importance to being a good neighbour, we cooperate closely with the relevant authorities and actively integrate ourselves into our environment.

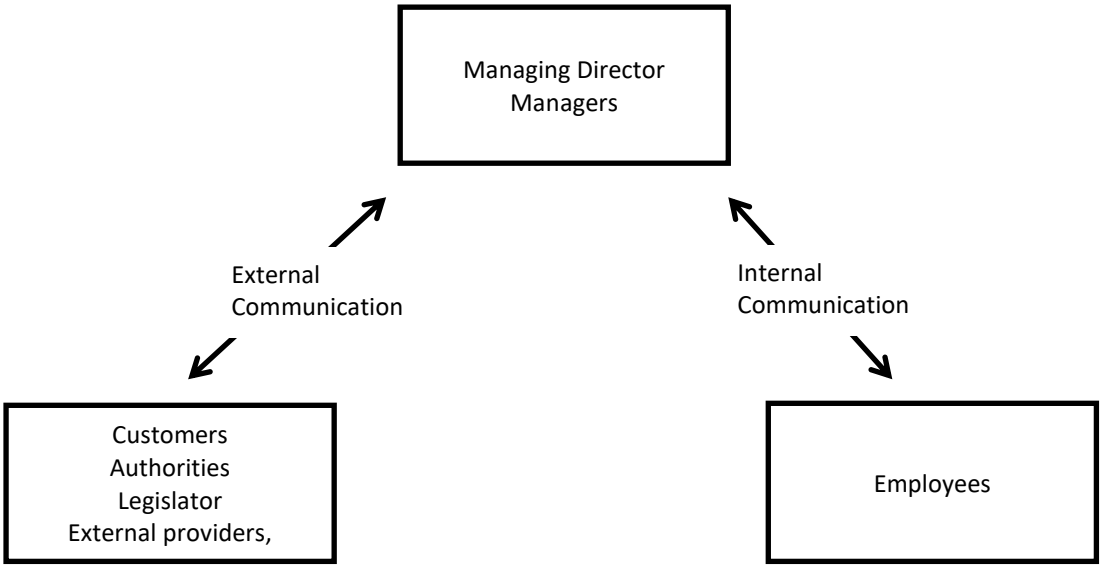
The management hereby undertakes to maintain, further develop and improve the quality management system and to fulfil applicable requirements.

Release: Managing Director

3. Resources

The management is responsible for the provision of all resources. Resources are defined as personnel, equipment, money and infrastructure, i.e. everything that is needed in the company to fulfil the requirements of the interested parties. To ensure the availability of the required resources, the resource requirements are determined at least once a year and documented in the management review.

Internal and external communication between those responsible takes place in writing or through personal discussions and ad hoc meetings.



The occupational safety requirements are fulfilled by an external occupational safety service provider.

The management is responsible for complying with and communicating the legal/regulatory requirements and its own requirements, as well as for the infrastructure and working environment.

Our employees receive regular further training.

We ensure that customer property of any kind is handled responsibly. If necessary, this is regulated by contract. Specific requirements for emergency measures are defined with the customer if necessary.

Knowledge of the organisation: The knowledge required to carry out our processes is determined by identifying training needs and defining the processes in the process descriptions. This knowledge is maintained and made available through constant communication with each other (in person, by e-mail) and documentation of the processes.

4. Processes

Our processes are divided into three process levels. Sub-processes are defined within these processes. Sub-processes are procedures within a process that lead to the expected result.

Management process

The management process represents a clearly defined structure of our company. The management process is used to determine the input and requirements of interested parties and provide the necessary resources.

Value creation process

Our value creation process is based on the requirements of our customers. The required inputs and expected results as well as criteria and procedures (including monitoring, measurements and the associated performance indicators) are defined for this value creation process. This ensures the effective implementation and management of this process.

Support process

The support process is provided to ensure that the value creation process runs smoothly. This ensures the realisation of customer requirements.

The interaction of the processes was determined and visualised in the process map.

Litigation risks

Potential process risks are assessed at least once a year or as required. Internal risk management is carried out using defined guidelines, e.g. on the basis of the relevant process instructions (SOP). Appropriate measures to minimise risks are defined based on the respective quality requirements of the products and processes if risks are identified. Their effectiveness is measured and evaluated as part of internal audits and management reviews. Customer-specific risk management requirements are also reflected, see Appendix 2.

5. Measurement, analysis and improvements

The effectiveness of the system is monitored by analysing customer satisfaction and the results of regular internal audits.

The management system is subject to planned and unplanned audits. These audits use objective evidence to determine compliance with the applicable instructions and the effectiveness of the measures taken. Necessary corrective measures are initiated and their implementation monitored.

The QM system is evaluated and further developed with the regular management review.

The fulfilment of customer requirements is ensured by measuring and monitoring the processes.

Corrective and improvement measures are systematically introduced in the ongoing sub-processes and their implementation is monitored.

6. Other applicable documents / Table of contents

Document	Description of the	Process owner
Manual	Manual	-
Organisation chart	Extra document	-
Process map	Extra document	-
Management process	Process	GF
Management assessment	Sub-process	GF
Risks and opportunities	Sub-process	GF
Internal audit	Sub-process	QMB
QM process	Sub-process	QMB
Training and skills (knowledge of the organisation)	Sub-process	GF
Value creation process	Process	GF
Enquiry and order process	Sub-process	Project manager
Dispo	Sub-process	Project manager/ Material planning
Work preparation, production order, production office	Sub-process	Product Responsible
Production and quality control	Sub-process	Product Responsible
Final inspection QA, packaging, dispatch, outgoing goods	Sub-process	Product Responsible
Support process	Process	GF
Purchasing	Sub-process	Purchasing
Incoming goods	Sub-process	Warehouse
Customer satisfaction	Sub-process	GF
Customer complaints	Sub-process	GF
Supplier evaluation	Sub-process	GF
Maintenance of the machines	Sub-process	Maintenance representative
Test equipment monitoring	Sub-process	Test equipment

Document	Description of the	Process owner
		representative

ANNEX 1

VA - Responsibility and authorisations

Process-related responsibilities and authorisations are defined in the sub-processes and VAs.

Management

- Corporate strategy
- Plan investments
- Preparation and approval of the management review and other QM documents
- Ensure that the processes deliver the intended results
- Ensure the integrity of the QM system, in the event of changes
- Identify, approve and plan training requirements, check the effectiveness of training courses
- Release audit programme (internal audit)
- Promotion of customer orientation in all areas
- Evaluation of measures to determine customer satisfaction and definition of further measures
- Define measures for handling complaints
- Initiate improvement measures
- Personnel planning
- Create new articles and define specifications
- Contracts with suppliers
- Ensure that the requirements of the standard are met

QMB (Quality Management Representative)

- Create a draft management review
- Definition and review of training intervals per department
- Regular training of employees with regard to quality specifications
- Monitoring of measures
- Update, check and release QM documentation
- Initiate continuous improvement of the QM system
- Plan, prepare and conduct internal audits
- Planning and implementation of supplier AUDIT
- Examination of the perception of quality responsibility of the respective persons

Project Manager R&D/Assistant to the Managing Director

- Technical and organisational management of the department / corresponding employees
- Personnel management of the department / corresponding employees
- Interface to the management
- Implementation of the QMS in his department
- Creating work instructions for the department
- Control of work processes in the department
- Identification of training needs in his department
- Realisation of (R&D) projects of / for the management
- Responsibility for office IT

Accounting/Personnel Management

- Technical and organisational management of the department / corresponding employees
- Personnel management of the department / corresponding employees
- Personnel planning and recruitment
- Checking, account assignment and posting of current business transactions
- Processing of customer transactions
- Timely and high-quality supply
- Invoice verification and management (incoming/outgoing)
- Coordination/communication with all parties relevant to personnel management
- Maintenance / management of the respective IT tools

Product Responsible

- Technical and organisational management of the department / corresponding employees
- Personnel management of the department / corresponding employees
- Coordination of production / assembly, dispatch, material planning and management
- Responsibility for the respective product - from development to delivery
- Coordination with internal order management
- Communication/coordination with customers
- Maintenance of documents/databases for the management of the respective products

Knitting mill manager

- Technical and organisational management of the department / corresponding employees

- Personnel management of the department / corresponding employees
- Interface to the management
- Material planning (yarn)
- Programming knitting technology
- Knitting machine operator
- Maintenance of documents/databases for production management

Specialist/employee

- Implementation of work instructions by the head of department
- Make suggestions for improvement to the head of department
- Submit training requirements to the head of department
- Acting and working independently
- Perform and document testing processes and their documentation in a professional manner
- Manufacture of ready-made products
- Production of compression bandages
- Packaging and dispatch

VA - Documented information

Purpose of the instruction

This instruction defines the control of documents, data carriers and records (= documented information).

Responsibility

The release and amendment of documents / data carriers and records can be seen in the Documents and data matrix. The distribution list is determined by the creator of the documents.

Matrix documents and data

Document	Creation/ updating	Review / Authorisation
Forms	All areas	GF
Company manual incl. annexes	QMB	GF

Creation / editing
All QM documents are controlled via the footer, e.g.
Date of the last change, creator, release, paginated page number. Changes to the manual are highlighted in colour. If texts are omitted when the manual is changed, this is labelled as such: [...]

Review / Authorisation

Documents are checked by the responsible persons defined in the matrix.
The document is deemed to have been released upon publication.

Distribution
The creator determines to whom the document is distributed.

External documents
External documents are assigned to the processes and archived according to their content.

Archiving / Destruction

Invalid documents are archived.
Old documents are destroyed at the earliest after the minimum retention period has expired.

Matrix records and retention period

Document	Who	Location	EDP / Paper	Period (min year)
Audit reports	QMB	QM folder	EDP	15
Management assessment	QMB	QM folder	EDP	15
Supplier evaluation	QMB	QM folder	EDP	15
Customer feedback	QMB	QM folder	EDP	15
Risk analysis	QMB	QM folder	EDP	15
List of standards and laws	QMB	QM folder	EDP	15
Training certificates	QMB	QM folder	Paper	15
Invalid QM documents	QMB	QM folder / archive	EDP	15
Customer documents	GF	Office	EDP/Paper	15
Supplier documents	GF	Office	EDP/Paper	15
Contracts	GF	Office	EDP/Paper	15
Time sheet	GF	Office	Paper	15
Test protocols	FL	Office	Paper	15
Test equipment list	FL	Office	EDP	15
Works certificates	AV/GF	Office	EDP	15
Proof of disposal	GF	Office	EDP/Paper	15
Complaints list	GF	Office	EDP/Paper	15
Familiarisation plan	GF	Office	EDP	15
Notice of defects / debit note	AV/EK	Office	EDP/Paper	15
Change documents	AV/GF	Office	EDP/Paper	15
Production documents	AV/FL	Office	EDP/Paper	15

Data backup

Data is backed up every 15 minutes on in-house servers that are virtually mirrored.
Data is backed up to external hard drives on a weekly basis.
The hard drive is stored in the company's safe.

ANNEX 2

The following QM measures were implemented for a specific Tec&Lifestyle customer to reduce process risks and for internal risk control:

1	Document management with the help of the "Confluence" collaboration tool
2	Procedural instructions (SOPs) for the clear definition of process flows, responsibilities and relevant documents
3	Routing cards in the production process to ensure clear identification of products in the value-added process
4	Change management process (change request / design review) for improved traceability of development and/or product changes